



Deploy Synergy to Share Your Devices

This article discusses a program called Synergy, which is used for sharing the mouse and keyboard of server with number of clients. By definition, the word 'synergy' implies that the whole is greater than the sum of its parts. This awesome software program clearly demonstrates this!

Do you have two or more computers at your desk? And how do you operate them? Like everyone else, by using the keyboard and mouse of each computer, right? Wouldn't it be great if you could use just a single keyboard and mouse to operate multiple computers? Well, you can do that with Synergy. So let's go ahead and explore this software's configuration and some of its troubleshooting techniques.

For demonstration purposes, I'll use Windows 7 and Ubuntu GNU/Linux. Figure 1 depicts the details of my set-up.

In my set-up, both the systems are laptops but any combination of desktop/laptop is fine. An external keyboard and mouse are connected to the Ubuntu machine. And with the help of Synergy, they will be used to operate both these machines. It doesn't matter whether the keyboard or mouse are connected via PS2, USB or wireless; whether the architecture is x86 or x64; or if the systems are connected

using a wired or wireless network. As long as both systems are reachable over the network, Synergy will do its job. So let us get our hands dirty with it.

An introduction to Synergy

Synergy is a software application that allows you to share a keyboard and a mouse between multiple systems. It is somewhat similar to the KVM (Keyboard, Video and Mouse) switch but is purely a software entity. It is convenient when a single user wants to operate multiple systems, and is also useful in situations in which several systems are connected to a monitor and the user wants to operate them using a single keyboard and mouse.

Synergy follows the client-server model, in which there is a single server and one or more clients. The server is the system to which the keyboard and mouse are physically connected. In my case, it is the Ubuntu machine. To operate another system, just move your mouse pointer to the other